115. Indian farmers are unhappy over the introduction of "Terminator Seed Technology" because the seeds produced by this technology are expected to:

(a) Show poor germination
(b) Form low-yielding plants despite the high quality
(c) Give rise to sexually sterile plants
(d) Given rise to plants incapable of forming viable seeds

Ans. (c) : The Terminator gene technology is also called, 'Genetic Use Restriction Technology (GURT), terminator gene is a specific genetic sequence inserted into a seed's DNA. Once activated by a synthetic chemical catalyst of the manufacturer's choosing, the sequence renders the seed and crop which produces sterile Plant. This means that the farmer cannot retain seeds for future crops as is the practice in India. The farmer has to repurchase the seeds at a heavy cost.

116. Which one of the following genetic diseases is sex-linked?

(a) Royal haemophilia
(b) Tay-Sachs disease
(c) Cystic fibrosis
(d) Hypertension

Ans. (a) : Royal hemophilia is sex- linked disease. Clotting of blood is abnormally delayed even small cut will result in non stop bleeding in the affected individual. Queen Victoria was a carrier of this disease and produce hemophilic descendents, so hemophilia is a royal disease.

SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

117. Low temperatures (Cryogenics) find application in :

(a) space travel, surgery and magnetic levitation
(b) surgery, magnetic levitation and telemetry
(c) space travel surgery and telemetry
(d) space travel, magnetic levitation and telemetry.

Ans. (a) : Cryogenics is the study of the production and behavior of materials at very low temperatures. Cryogenic processes are used in Space Travel, surgery and transportation like magnetic levitation.

ENVIRONMENT AND ECOLOGY

118. The minimum land area recommended for forest cover to maintain proper Ecological balance in India is:

(a) 25% (b) 33%
(c) 43% (d) 53%

Ans. (b) : For proper ecological balance, 33% of forest land is recommended. In 2019, total forest cover in India was 21.67% only.

119. "India has the largest population of the Asian X. Today, there are just about 20,000 to 25,000 X in their natural habitat spreading across the evergreen forests, dry thorn forests, swamps and grasslands. Their prime habitats are however the moist deciduous forests. The X population in India ranges from North-West India where they are found in the forest divisions of Dehradun. Bijnor and Nainital districts of UP to the Western Ghats in the states of Karnataka and Kerala and in Tamil Nadu.

In Central India, their population is distributed is southern Bihar and Orissa. In the East, they are seen in North Bengal, Assam and a few other states."

The animal "X" referred to in this quotation is:

(a) Lion
(b) Elephant
(c) Tiger
(d) One-horned rhinoceros

Ans. (b) : The animal X referred in question is elephant. The population of elephants in Northern India ranges in the western Himalayan foothills from Dehradun to Nepal in Uttarakhand and Uttar Pradesh. The North-Eastern distribution is found from Sikkim, north Bengal, Assam eastwards till Mishmi Hills in Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland, Meghalaya, Manipur, Mizoram and Tripura. The central distribution occurs in south Bihar, south Bengal, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh and Orissa. The southern distribution has its presence in Western Ghats and parts of Karnataka, Tamil Nadu and Kerala.

120. Which one of the following is a useful functional association between fungi and the roots of higher plants?

(a) Bio-fertilizer (b) Coralloid root
(c) Lichen (d) Mycorrhiza

Ans. (d) : Mycorrhiza is a useful functional association between fungi and the roots of higher plants in which fungi absorb nutrients from the soil as their roots are not such strong and the trees provide food to the fungi. The best example is Orchid mycorrhiza.

121. The first marine sanctuary in India, having within its bounds coral reefs, mollusca, dolphins, tortoises and various kinds of sea birds, has been established in:

(a) Sundarbans (b) Chilka Lake
(c) Gulf of Kachchh (d) Lashadweep

Ans. (b) : The first marine sanctuary in India, having within its bounds coral reefs, mollusca, dolphins, tortoises and various kinds of sea birds, has been established in Chilka Lake.

122. Which one of the following legislations does not deal with the protection of environment?

(a) The Water (Cess) Act, 1977
(b) The Forest (Conservation) Act, 1980
(c) The Public Liability Insurance Act, 1991
(d) The Port Laws Amendment, 1997

Ans. (a) : The Water (Cess) Act, 1977 is related to water and irrigation, not with the protection of environment other acts in the question deal with protection of environment.

CURRENT AFFAIRS

123. Which one of the countries labelled as 1, 2, 3 and 4 on the given map was grantee membership of G-15 in its VII summit at Kuala-Lumpur?



(a) 1 (b) 2
(c) 3 (d) 4

Ans. (d) : Kenya was granted as the 16th member of G–15 countries which is marked as '4' in the given map.

124. In the November 1998 Composite Dialogue Process between India and Pakistan, three contentious issues listed below as 1, 2 and 3 were discussed.



Contentious Issues

1. Disengagement of troops.
2. Settlement of boundary dispute.
3. Sharing river water.

Match the issues with the areas marked in the map as A, B and C and select the correct answer using the codes given below:

Codes:

	A	B	C
(a)	2	1	3
(b)	2	3	1
(c)	1	3	2
(d)	3	2	1

Ans. (b) : During composite dialogue process between India and Pakistan in November 1998, three contentious issues were discussed i.e. settlement of Boundary issues in Rann of Kutch, marked A in the map, sharing of river water of Indus tributary marked 'B' map and disengagement of troops in Siyachin marked "C" in the map.

125. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists:

List-I (Writers)	List-II (Books)
A. Sashi Tharoor	1. Clear Light of Day
B. Amitav Ghosh	2. Circle of Reason
C. Anita Desai	3. Love and Longing in Bombay
D. Vikram Chandra	4. Show Business

Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	4	2	1	3
(b)	4	2	3	1
(c)	2	4	1	3
(d)	2	4	3	1

Ans. (a) : Shashi Tharoor is the writer of "Show Business, Amitav Ghosh wrote "Circle of Reason", Anita Desai wrote "Clear light of Day" and Vikram Chandra wrote" Love and longing in Bombay". These were best selling novels.

MISCELLANEOUS

126. In a group of Five people, K, L and M are ambitious, M, N and R are honest, L, M and N are intelligent and K, N and R are industrious. Among these neither industrious nor ambitious person (s) would include:

(a) K alone (b) L and R
(c) M and N (d) none in the group